Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish
It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

CONFESSIONS – Daily after Morning Mass (except Sunday and Holydays) & St Mary's at 7pm on Wednesday (before Evening Mass) and Saturday 11am/12Noon & 5.30pm/6.15pm

St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning g their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction".

HOLY FACE OF JESUS: – Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

OUR LADY UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA: - Continues in St Mary's Church on Wednesday evening 21 October after 7.30pm Mass.

DO THIS IN MEMORY – P4 preparation for First Holy Communion takes place at 11.30am Mass in St Mary's Church today (Sunday)

OCTOBER DEVOTIONS:
In St Mary's Church each Sunday evening at 6pm during October.

PARISH OF GREENLOUGH – will hold a Mass in St Oliver Plunkett Church, Clady, at 7.30pm on Friday 23 October to remember all those whose funerals were celebrated under Covid restrictions. Everyone is very welcome!

PIONEER TOTAL ABSTINENCE ASSOCIATION: Requests for PTAA pins currently processed per written application to Pastoral Centre Office.

MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID TRAINING COURSE - will take place on 27th & 28th Oct from 9.30am/4.30pm in Heaney Homeplace, 45 Main Street, Bellaghy. Please Note – to be eligible to apply you must live within or directly deliver a service within the Northern HSC Trust area. E-mail: denise@cwsan.org or phone 07540969623

ENVELOPE COLLECTION - Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,433.00. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations to the church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded.
Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button.

ROSARY ON BENONE BEACH this Sunday 18th Oct at 3pm

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB In Fairhill Youth Centre on Tuesdays at 10.30am.

GLEN GAA Website www.wattygrahamsgac.com Lotto Numbers 44:47:24:38: No winner. Next week £13,500. Three £50 winners. Cara Hampson, Suzanne Brock and Niall Kelly. --Flyover £16,800 in 45 Nos. or less.

FALLAGHLOON HALL - BINGO- Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

MAGHERA HERITAGE CENTRE – 'Maghera Memories & Itchy Feet' talk by John Burns on Tues 20 Oct at 7.30pm. Afternoon Tea Dance at Walsh's Hotel, music by Kenny Paul on Thurs 29 Oct from 2pm/4pm. Copper smithing Workshop on Sat 31 Oct, 11am/2pm. Watercolour painting class coming in Nov.
See Facebook/Instagram page for more details.

AN CARN - CHAIR AEROBICS - Thurs 22 Oct from 9.30am/10.30am at An Carn, £5.
Bilingual Comedy Night: Funny Focail – Half trí Ghaeilge agus half through English, providing a space to practice and learn cúpla focail, and most importantly to have a laugh with comedians Diane O'Connor, Louise O'Toole & Aideen McQueen! on Sat 24 Oct at 7.30pm. £10
Half-term break: Kids Animations, Workshop - Kids will use LEGO to create their own stop-motion animations, learning the basics of animating a short film and they'll also get to produce a live-action film using visual effects! on Tues 27 Oct from 10am/2pm. £15-8+

45-CARDS - re commence on Monday 26 Oct at 7.30pm

SLAUGHTNEIL GAC – BINGO – on Sat 24 Oct at 8pm. 11-Page Book - £10, Line £20. House £40, Flyover £50, House £100, Last Line £50, House £200.

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP – We will be delivering our first-ever Kids' Papier-mâché workshop during the Hallowe'en holidays on Tuesday 27 Oct from 1pm/3pm approximately. Our tutor will be Louie Winward. Louie is no stranger to Swatragh, but this will be her first time delivering a workshop for us. Open to boys and girls and geared towards 8–12-year-olds. Guaranteed to be messy but §marvellous. Parents welcome to stay too. Places allocated on a first come, first served basis. Phone: Anne McNicholl 07714757643
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DIOCESAN YOUTH CO ORDINATOR – 1 Year Fixed Term Contract with possible extension. 16 hours per week (including evening and weekend work) Place of Work: Gate Lodge, Catechetical Centre, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry. Salary: £12,688-£13,498 per annum .Applications must be returned to by Thurs 22 October. Tel. 7126 2302 or email:- recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Please remember to put your clocks back one hour next Saturday night

30th Sunday in Ordinary Time

25th October 2026

One Question, One Answer: Two Sides, Same Coin

Another week, another trap. Last Sunday they came with a coin. This week a lawyer comes with a question: which commandment is the greatest?

Jesus does not hesitate. Love the Lord your God with all your heart, all your soul, all your mind. Then, though nobody asked, he adds a second and says it is like the first: love your neighbour as yourself. On these two hang the whole Law and the Prophets.

Think back to that coin. Every coin has two sides, heads and tails, but nobody has ever spent one side of a coin. It is one piece of metal or it is nothing. That is what Jesus is saying about love. Love of God is one side. Love of neighbour is the other. Try to separate them and you are left holding something worthless. You cannot love the God you have never seen while ignoring the neighbour you see every day. And you cannot truly love the neighbour without the God whose image that neighbour bears.

That is the link. Last week Jesus asked whose image was on the coin. We said that we bear God's image. So does the stranger, the widow, the orphan, the man whose cloak is held in pledge. The first reading is blunt about it: give the cloak back by sunset, because it is all he has to sleep in. God's compassion lands in practical places, in coins and cloaks.

St Paul tells the Thessalonians that their faith is known everywhere. Not because of their preaching, but because people saw how they lived. Their faith had two sides, but it was never two-faced. Like the coin, it was solid and the same.

Loving God is what we do in Church. Loving neighbour is how the world knows we mean it. Two sides. Same coin. Spend it well.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2745.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1370.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 25 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place on Sunday 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Legion of Mary Rosary at the Mass Rock, Tulacorr Heights tomorrow Monday 26 October at 12 noon.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism

Darragh Frankie McCay

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Anthony Patton, 1 Hazel Gardens

Marie McNulty, 32 Millhaven

Lisa Kelly, 103 Beech Mount Village

Marie McNally, 61 Carrick Strand

Maureen McCrossan, 3 Innisfree Gardens

Rosemary Donnell, Castlederg

Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries

Seamus McLaughlin, Kieran Doherty, Pam McLaughlin

Noel McCrory, Patsy Kennedy, Martin McElwee

Deirdre Conway, Kitty McLaughlin, Kathleen Moss

George McGinley, Pat Nugent, Damien McClay

Charlie Flanagan, Maybid Doherty, Edie McDermott

Mamie McNulty, Noreen Doherty, Derek Fletcher

Mary McLaughlin, Gregory Forbes, Philomen Murray

William McLaughlin, Tony Gillespie, Charlie Neeson

Billie Hamilton

Vocations St. Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was *'…with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel…'* We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Baptism Dates Melmount

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14, 21 & 28.

December: Saturday 12; Sunday 20.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Pilgrimage to Fatima 5 July 2027 for 7 Nights Led by *Spiritual Director:* Fr Sean O'Donnell. *Group Leader:* Patricia Moore. For booking and more information contact Patricia Moore 07743936548 or Anne McCambridge 07784953408.

Volunteers are Required one morning per month to help with Eucharistic Adoration for St. Mary's P.S. children as part of the Children of the Eucharist (COTE) programme. Safeguarding requirements apply. If you would like to get involved, please leave your contact details with the Parish Office.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for November to the Parish Office on **Monday 16 November from 2.00pm - 4.30pm.** The Draw for November will take place on Thursday 19 November at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane (DLP) on 07596500793/

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Or

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Forty Hours St. Mary's Church, Melmount Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November.

Sunday 8 November 2026

8.00am *Morning Prayer*

11.30am *Mass*

3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*

6.00pm *Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer and Stations of the Cross*

9.00pm *Rosary*

9.30pm *Night Prayer*

Monday 9 November 2026

12.00am *Rosary*

3.00am *Rosary*

6.00am *Angelus and Chaplet*

8.00am *Morning Prayer & Rosary*

10.00am *Mass*

12.00pm *Angelus and Midday Prayer*

3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*

6.00pm *Angelus and Chaplet*

8.00pm *Holy Hour: with Evening Prayer and Rosary*

9.30pm *Night Prayer*

12.00am *Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours*

If You Are Willing To Volunteer To Help Cover An Hour Or Hours During The 40hrs, Please Let Us Know What You Will Do By Filling Out A Commitment Card Found At The Back Of The Church Or Online And Posting In The Box At The Sacristy Or Into Fr Sean, The Parish Office Or By Email. It Would Be Good To Get All The Hours Well Covered To Maintain A Continuous Presence Of People With The Lord, And To Be There For The Holy Hour On Sunday And Monday Evenings.

Sion Mills Group of Alcohol Anonymous will hold a public information meeting on Wednesday 28 October at 8.30pm in Sion Mills Community Centre. Everyone welcome.

Derry & Strabane PCSP – *Staying Safe, Staying Independent* A day of FREE road safety and scam awareness for the over 65's. Monday 26 October at 10.00am in the Bog Hall, Sion Mills. Everyone welcome.

The Parish Draw for October took place on Thursday 22 October. The winners are as follows:

£500: 1204 Karen McMahon – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£250: 1105 Paul Coulter – *Declan Duffy*

£250: 1957 Christine Gallagher – *Deirdre Martin*

£250: 1136 Jim Gallagher – *Ann Donaghey*

£150: 1324 Sandra O'Doherty – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£150: 1030 Brian Tracey – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£150: 2007 Noel & Delia Devine – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1038 Angela & John Quinn – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£100: 1361 Nora Kennedy – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1518 Alice Houston – *Katrina Houston*